

MARKETING SWEET · SALES TEAM TOOLKIT · SESSION 15

Pitch High. Read the Room. Hold the Line.

Strategy session: profit not turnover, the buyer's dialect, asymmetric openers, and the in-out dance that closes deals without pressure.

WHAT'S INSIDE

- 01 Profit > turnover**
Size the pitch to the bank account, not the revenue.
- 02 Read the room**
Build the buyer profile sheet before every meeting.
- 03 Pitch high**
Anchor at the top. Let them bring you down.
- 04 Speak the dialect**
Flashy vs utilitarian. Same product, different language.
- 05 Show, don't tell**
Generic claims die. Specific evidence sells.
- 06 The narrative opener**
Asymmetric questions. Every answer leads to the same place.
- 07 Hold the line + dance**
Reluctance sells. The in-out rhythm closes.
- 08 Daily reference card**
Print and pin. Read before each pitch.

Profit is king. Not turnover.

Size the pitch to what hits their bank account - not what shows on the invoice.



WORKED EXAMPLE — A BARRISTER

Hourly rate × billable hours × 5 days × 52 weeks gives turnover. Strip out living expenses and the actual disposable profit is six figures. A website that costs less than a single week of their take-home is not expensive - it's chump change. Size the pitch to that number.

THE SELF-CHECK

If the deal you're about to pitch lands inside their weekly take-home, you're pitching too low. Recalibrate before you walk in.

Read the room.

Fill in the profile sheet before every meeting. The pitch writes itself when the persona is locked.

BUYER PROFILE · FILL BEFORE WALKING IN

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INDUSTRY / BUSINESS

YEARS IN BUSINESS

_____ staff: _____ trucks/equipment: _____

LOCATION

TURNOVER (ANNUAL)

\$ _____

ESTIMATED PROFIT

\$ _____ (capacity-to-spend lens)

PERSONA · CIRCLE THE ONES THAT FIT

Flashy

Utilitarian

Value-seeker

Status-seeker

Big ego

Small ego

Time-poor

Hands-on

Skeptical

Eager

DECISION MAKER?

☐ YES

☐ NO

☐ PARTLY (with spouse / partner)

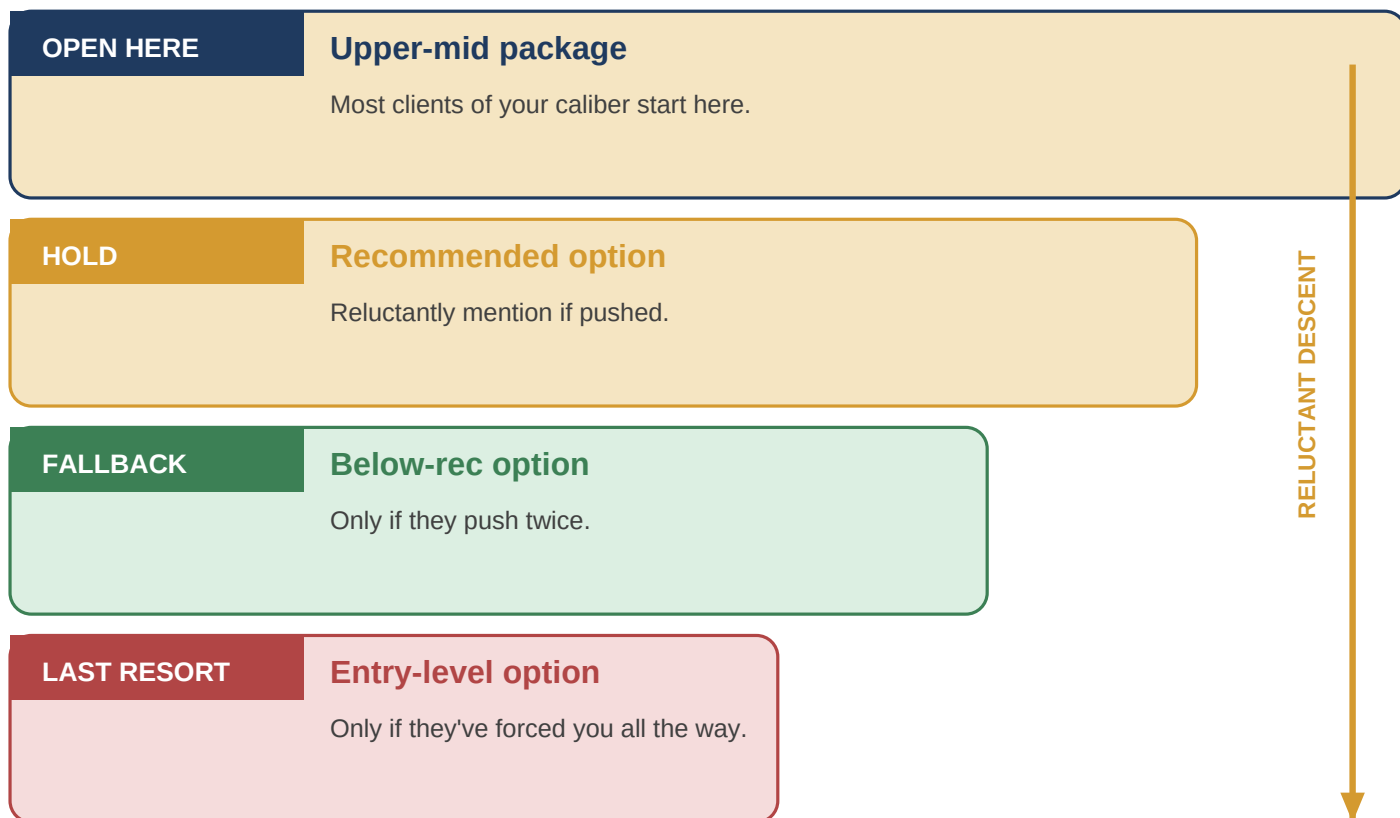
NARRATIVE / SECTOR OUTLOOK

THE RULE

If the persona isn't circled before you walk in, the pitch is a guess.

Pitch high. Let them choke.

Anchor at the top. Reluctantly come down. Never open with the cheapest option.



THE RULE

Going in cheap signals you misread the buyer. Going in high gets a reaction you can work with. Drop the moral compass - it's the rep's insecurity, not the buyer's reality.

Speak their dialect.

Same English. Different vocabulary. The wrong dialect kills a good product.

FLASHY BUYER

Premium suit. Premium car. The watch. Travels business. Buys the brand, not the spec.

WHAT TO SELL:

- Looks. Credibility. Prestige.
- "Be the best in your industry online."
- Show top-tier competitors.
- Visual quality of the product.
- Exclusivity. "Most don't get this."

POWER WORDS:

caliber**top-tier****premium****industry-leading****exclusive**

UTILITARIAN BUYER

Work ute. No-frills phone. Brick-and-mortar shop. Hasn't done marketing. Buys the spec, not the brand.

WHAT TO SELL:

- Function. Process. Certainty.
- "Silent winner or silent killer."
- Lost leads. Missed referrals.
- The process map. The checklist.
- Specific support metrics.

POWER WORDS:

chump change**process****support ticket****ROI****lost leads**

FIVE-MINUTE TEST

Watch what they pull out. Phone, watch, car keys. The object names the dialect.

Show, don't tell.

Every generic claim your competitor would also say is a wasted sentence. Replace with specifics.

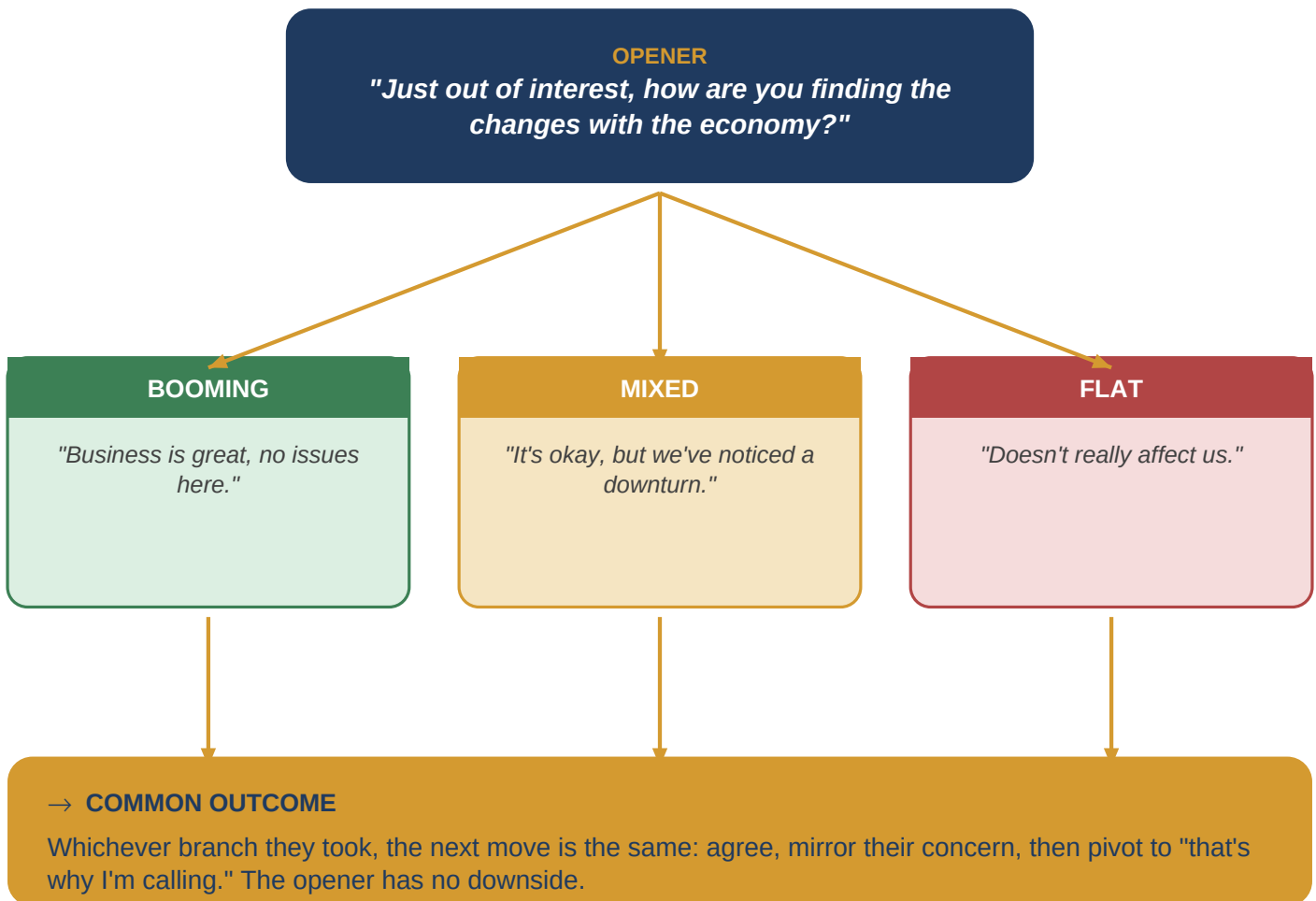
GENERIC <i>"We have an experienced team."</i>	→	SPECIFIC "Taylor leads your build - over a decade designing websites."
GENERIC <i>"We have great customer service."</i>	→	SPECIFIC "We run a support ticketing system with response-time metrics."
GENERIC <i>"We have a clear process."</i>	→	SPECIFIC "There's a 170-point checklist behind every build - here it is."
GENERIC <i>"We deliver quality work."</i>	→	SPECIFIC "Here are three of your competitors. Through our process, this is what you'd look like."
GENERIC <i>"We're responsive."</i>	→	SPECIFIC "Send a support ticket at 2am - you get a reply by morning."

THE DISH, NOT THE RESTAURANT

You don't say "the restaurant has good food." You say "you've got to try the duck." Once you're on the dish, it's no longer about the restaurant.

The narrative opener.

Asymmetric questions. Whichever answer they give, the next sentence is the same.



PREP RULE

Read the news before pitching. Know the narrative. Buyers can smell unprepared. Two asymmetric questions ready before every meeting.

Hold the line + the out-in dance.

Reluctance sells. Release pressure, apply pressure, release again. Let them choose.

DON'T SWIVEL

Buyer says "that's a bit much." Rep instantly drops the price, drops the package, moves to the cheaper option. Movement reads as desperation.

RESULT:

Credibility collapses. The buyer smells the swivel. The deal closes lower or not at all.

HOLD THE LINE

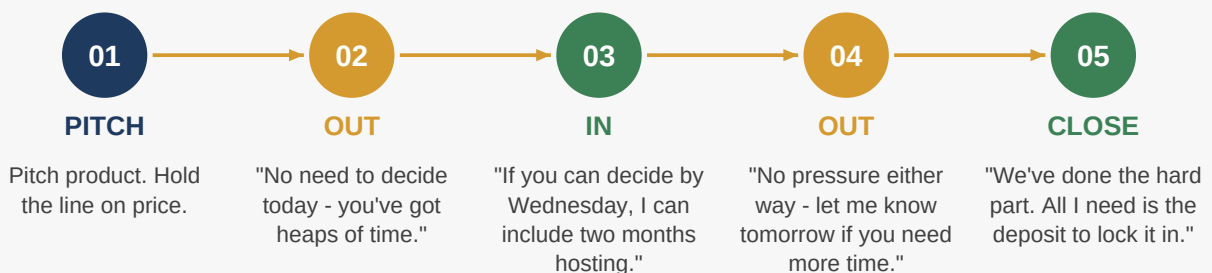
Reluctantly mention the alternative: "If you really want to, there's another option, but I wouldn't recommend it." Discouraging it triggers desire.

RESULT:

Buyer leans in. The duck on the menu. The Krispy Kreme principle - scarcity drives desire.

THE OUT-IN DANCE

Five-step rhythm. Release pressure, apply, release, apply, close.



REMEMBER

You're not pressuring them. You're giving them an opportunity to make a decision.

Daily reference card.

Print and pin. Read before every pitch.

DO · EVERY PITCH

- Calculate profit, not just turnover.
- Fill the persona row before walking in.
- Anchor at the upper-mid package.
- Match the dialect - flashy or utilitarian.
- Replace every generic claim with specifics.
- Open with an asymmetric question.
- Hold the line - reluctantly offer alternatives.
- Run the out-in-out-in dance.
- Use "most clients of your caliber..."
- Active-listen - regurgitate three things.

DON'T · EVER

- Don't pitch to turnover.
- Don't open with the cheapest option.
- Don't say "great customer service."
- Don't swivel after the first objection.
- Don't drop price without retreating elsewhere.
- Don't go in for the kill on first contact.
- Don't predict the buyer's no.
- Don't wear the moral compass for the buyer.
- Don't pad the day with shallow meetings.
- Don't say "I reckon" - say "absolutely."

WATCH-OUTS

- Forgetting to read the news that morning.
- Treating the alternative option as easy out.
- Using "all clients" instead of "most clients."
- Going generic when nervous.
- Asking yes/no questions instead of asymmetric.
- Letting two-hour windows shrink to thirty.
- Skipping the regurgitation step.
- Calling the deposit a "setup fee."
- Showing up without a profile sheet filled.
- Going in cheap to look ethical.

THE ONE-LINER

Profit not turnover. Read the room. Pitch high, hold the line. Dance the pressure.